

ALA BEN KHALIFA

Software Architect | Tech Lead (Backend & Microservices)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Architect and Technical Leader with 6+ years of experience designing, building, and scaling cloud-native platforms across AWS and Azure. Currently serving as CTO and Co-Founder of a DOOH advertising startup, where I single-handedly architected and deployed the entire cloud infrastructure and software platform on AWS, attracting enterprise clients including BYD, Tunisie Telecom, and Carrefour. Concurrently leading cloud migration and API platform initiatives for major automotive and industrial brands at MaibornWolff, a German technology consultancy. Proven track record in microservices architecture, infrastructure-as-code, and leading engineering teams on complex distributed systems. University-level instructor in Microservices Architecture and Spring Framework.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (SAA-C03) — Amazon Web Services
 - Microsoft Certified: Azure Developer Associate (AZ-204) — Microsoft
 - VMware Spring Certified Professional 2024 v2 — VMware / Broadcom
 - iSAQB Certified Professional for Software Architecture – Foundation Level (CPSA-FL) — iSAQB
 - Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) — Scrum.org
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CORE COMPETENCIES

Cloud Architecture: AWS (ECS Fargate, RDS, ElastiCache, S3, CloudFront, ALB, ECR, VPC, Secrets Manager) · Azure (API Management, App Services, Azure AD, Key Vault) · Multi-cloud strategy

Infrastructure & DevOps: Terraform (IaC) · GitHub Actions CI/CD · Docker · Kubernetes · SonarQube

Backend & Architecture: Microservices · Spring Boot · Spring Security · Spring Data · NestJS · .NET / C# · Event-driven architecture · REST APIs · WebSocket · OAuth2 · MQTT · RabbitMQ · Domain Driven Design

Data & Storage: PostgreSQL · MongoDB · Redis · Firebase

Programming Languages: Java · Kotlin · TypeScript · C#

AI & Emerging Tech: RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) · AI-assisted agentic development · LLM integration

Leadership: Technical architecture decisions · Team management · Mentoring · Cross-functional coordination · Agile / Scrum · Stakeholder communication

Languages: Arabic (Native) · French (Professional) · English (Professional)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer (CTO) & Co-Founder

VERSE — Digital Out-of-Home Advertising Platform · Tunis, Tunisia *2024 – Present*

- Architected and built from scratch a full-stack DOOH advertising platform that displays targeted advertisements on venue screens across restaurants, cafes, and bars, with planned UK market expansion
- Designed and deployed the entire AWS cloud infrastructure: ECS Fargate with ALB for WebSocket support, RDS PostgreSQL 15, ElastiCache Redis 7, S3 + CloudFront CDN, ECR container registry, Secrets Manager, and NAT Gateway
- Implemented full infrastructure-as-code using Terraform with automated CI/CD pipelines via GitHub Actions, enabling reproducible deployments and zero-downtime releases
- Attracted enterprise-level advertisers including BYD, Tunisie Telecom, and Carrefour, validating product-market fit with major regional and international brands
- Sole technical owner responsible for all architecture decisions, backend development, cloud infrastructure, DevOps, and platform reliability

Tech: AWS (ECS Fargate, RDS, ElastiCache, S3, CloudFront, ALB, VPC, ECR, Secrets Manager) · Terraform · GitHub Actions · PostgreSQL 15 · Redis 7 · WebSocket · Docker

Lead Software Engineer

MaibornWolff GmbH (German Technology Consultancy) · Tunis, Tunisia *October 2024 – Present*

Mercedes-Benz — PlaTo Migration to MO360

- Led the migration of a production web application (PlaTo) from standard Azure infrastructure to MO360, Mercedes-Benz's proprietary Azure-based PaaS platform
- Analyzed existing system architecture, identified technical and operational risks, and designed a phased migration strategy ensuring minimal downtime and business continuity
- Applied cloud-native architectural patterns to improve scalability, reliability, and cost-efficiency

- Acted as technical lead, aligning architectural decisions with business requirements and platform constraints

Husky Injection Molding Systems — Cloud Architecture & Performance Optimization

- Reverse-engineered existing Azure cloud infrastructure and codified it using Terraform (Infrastructure as Code)
- Designed and executed load testing strategies to identify system bottlenecks, delivering strategic recommendations for infrastructure scalability and cost-efficiency
- Designed and implemented an API integration architecture using Azure API Management to synchronize data from customer factories with Husky's internal systems

Mercedes-Benz — KT+ Factory Software

- Developed new features for KT+ factory software using Domain Driven Design
- Enhanced system performance and resolved critical production issues

Tech: Azure · Terraform · Azure API Management · .NET / C# · Domain Driven Design · Load Testing · Cloud Migration

Senior Software Engineer

MaibornWolff GmbH · Tunis, Tunisia *October 2022 – October 2024*

Rolls-Royce Motor Cars — Whispers Platform

- Grew into a leadership role, managing a team of 4 engineers (3 Seniors + 1 Lead) on Whispers, an exclusive digital platform connecting Rolls-Royce customers and dealers through iOS and Android applications
- Owned architecture decisions across 10 microservices built with Spring Boot (Java/Kotlin), following event-driven architecture principles
- Deployed and operated services in a cloud environment on AWS with Kubernetes for container orchestration
- Integrated MQTT-based real-time messaging between backend services and mobile clients
- Drove CI/CD best practices, code quality standards via SonarQube, and automated testing strategies
- Mentored and coached team members, fostering a collaborative and growth-oriented engineering culture

Tech: Spring Boot · Kotlin · Java · Microservices · AWS · Kubernetes · Docker · MQTT · PostgreSQL · Firebase · SonarQube

Software Engineer

MaibornWolff GmbH · Tunis, Tunisia *October 2020 – October 2022*

Rolls-Royce Motor Cars — Whispers Platform

- Developed microservices backend and native Android/iOS mobile applications for Whispers, a distributed platform serving Rolls-Royce's global customer base
- Designed and developed backend services using Spring Boot (Java/Kotlin) following microservice principles
- Built Android applications using Kotlin, Jetpack Compose, and MVVM architecture; iOS applications using Swift and SwiftUI
- Migrated legacy Drupal backend to Spring Boot microservices, improving maintainability and performance
- Implemented real-time communication between services and clients using MQTT messaging protocol
- Worked with containerized deployments using Docker and Kubernetes

Tech: Spring Boot · Java · Kotlin · Swift · Android · iOS · MVVM · Jetpack Compose · Docker · Kubernetes · MQTT · PostgreSQL · Firebase

Software Engineer

Talan Tunisie · Tunis, Tunisia *February 2019 – October 2020*

Byblos — Talan Group Enterprise ERP

- Developed and maintained Byblos, Talan Group's enterprise ERP system, contributing to a major architectural modernization initiative
- Led the migration from Java EE / JSF monolithic architecture to Spring Boot / Angular microservices, reducing deployment complexity and improving team velocity
- Decomposed monolithic components into independent, scalable microservices
- Implemented asynchronous messaging between services using RabbitMQ for improved system decoupling and reliability
- Developed new ERP features including financial reporting and analytics modules

Tech: Spring Boot · Angular · Java EE · JSF · RabbitMQ · PostgreSQL · Microservices Architecture

EDUCATION

Software Engineering Diploma — ESPRIT (Private Higher School of Engineering and Technology), Tunis
· 2016 – 2019

Bachelor's Degree, Electronics & Communications Engineering — ISIMM (High Institute of Informatics and Mathematics), Monastir · 2012 – 2016

ADDITIONAL

- **Teaching:** Microservices Architecture (SOA) & Spring Framework Trainer at ENSIT (National Higher School of Engineering of Tunis) — September 2022 – Present
- **Interests:** Cloud architecture, AI-assisted development, smart home automation, automotive technology